ABC DIGITAL SERVICES

Active Directory Account Lockout, MFA Reset, and Conditional Access

Approved IT Knowledge Article Pack

Document ID	Version	Status	Effective date
ADS-KB-IAM-003	1.0	Approved for capstone use	06 Nov 2026

Knowledge owner	Review cycle	Classification	Issue category
Identity & Access Management	Every 6 months	Internal	Identity & Access

Fictional organization and sample operating procedures

How to use this article

This document is authoritative only for the fictional ABC Digital Services (ADS) capstone environment. The assistant may explain and recommend these steps, but must not execute privileged actions, approve expenditure, change access, or close a case on the user's behalf.

Retrieval metadata	Value
Document ID	ADS-KB-IAM-003
Category	Identity & Access
Products / assets	Entra ID, Active Directory, Microsoft Authenticator, Conditional Access, BitLocker PIN
Platform	Microsoft Entra ID, Windows 11 Hybrid Joined, iOS/Android Authenticator
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Superseded by	None

Safety boundary: Never request passwords, MFA codes, recovery keys, private keys, or full payment-card data. Stop and escalate if there is smoke, swelling, electric shock, suspected compromise, or possible data loss.

1. Resolve recurring Active Directory account lockouts

Field	Guidance
Common user phrases	"account locked out every 15 minutes", "AD password lock", "cached credentials locking account"
Default priority	P2 High
Objective	Identify stale credential source and unlock user account safely.
Minimum intake	Employee ID; UPN; timestamp of recent password change; list of enrolled mobile devices and RDP sessions.

Procedure

1. Verify user identity through approved manager callback or video verification—never ask for passwords or MFA codes.

2. Check lockout caller workstation in AD security logs (e.g., stale Windows Credential Manager, mobile mail app, or disconnected RDP session).

3. Instruct user to clear saved corporate entries in Windows Credential Manager (`control /name Microsoft.CredentialManager`).

4. Sign out of disconnected terminal server sessions and update Wi-Fi 802.1X password on mobile phones.

5. Unlock the AD account and monitor for 15 minutes to confirm lockouts cease.

Resolution and escalation

Outcome	Criteria
Resolve when	Stale credential source is purged and account remains unlocked for 30+ minutes.
Escalate when	Lockouts originate from unknown external IPs (suspected password spray attack).
Evidence to record	Source workstation name, identity verification method, lockout counter reset.
Forbidden actions	Disabling account lockout threshold policy; asking user for their current or old password.

2. Re-register Microsoft Authenticator MFA after phone replacement

Field	Guidance
Common user phrases	"new phone MFA broken", "lost authenticator app", "cannot approve sign-in prompt"
Default priority	P2 High
Objective	Rebind MFA hardware token after strict out-of-band identity proofing.
Minimum intake	Employee ID; manager confirmation; new mobile device OS version.

Procedure

1. Perform mandatory live video identity verification with government/corporate photo ID and manager confirmation.

2. Issue a single-use Temporary Access Pass (TAP) valid for 60 minutes via the IAM admin workflow.

3. Guide user to `aka.ms/mysecurityinfo` to delete the old phone registration and pair the new Microsoft Authenticator app.

4. Verify push notification with number matching works before closing the ticket.

Resolution and escalation

Outcome	Criteria
Resolve when	New Authenticator device is verified and old device registration is removed.
Escalate when	User fails identity verification or reports unsolicited MFA fatigue push prompts.
Evidence to record	Manager approval ID, identity verification log, old device removal confirmation.
Forbidden actions	Issuing a TAP over unverified email/chat; asking user to read out an SMS/MFA one-time code.

General ticket handling rules

Priority	Use when
P1 Critical	Widespread outage, active security threat, severe safety risk, or executive-critical service unavailable. Page the major-incident or security team immediately.
P2 High	User cannot perform time-critical work and no practical workaround exists. Target assignment within 30 minutes.
P3 Normal	Single-user degradation or standard fulfillment request. Target assignment within 4 business hours.
P4 Low	Information request, planned change, or non-urgent accessory request. Target assignment within 1 business day.

Standard ticket record

Record requestor, business justification, device or application, asset tag where applicable, location, symptoms, error text, start time, impact, troubleshooting attempted, approvals, evidence, result, and next owner. Do not paste secrets or unnecessary personal data.

Knowledge quality and review

The knowledge owner reviews this article every six months and after any major process, product, security, or supplier change. Superseded versions must be excluded from retrieval. Conflicts are resolved in favor of the newest approved article; otherwise the assistant must disclose the conflict and recommend escalation.

Reference basis

• Secure AI Troubleshooting Assistant BRD v1.0: approved content, metadata, ordered guidance, citations, verification, safe fallback, and escalation.

• NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3 (2025): Detect, Respond, Recover, and continuous improvement concepts for security-related incidents.

• Microsoft Intune and Windows Autopilot documentation: managed application deployment, device enrollment, assignment, and lifecycle practices.

• ITIL-aligned service management practices: incident, request, change, asset, and knowledge management concepts.